"JETRO Business Brief" dated 2026/10/26

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ASIA-OCEANIA

Xiaoma Intelligence to conduct robotaxi trials in London in partnership with Uber (China, UK)
From Guangzhou

China releases "Opinion on Development of New Quality Productive Forces," emphasizing upgrading of traditional industries (China)
From Beijing

CATL and Ceres sign cooperation agreement; accelerating construction of Phase 2 production line at Ceres factory (China)
From Chengdu

Hong Kong Stock Exchange announces new index "S&P 500 & HKEX Tech 100," jointly developed with S&P Dow Jones Indices (Hong Kong, US)
From Hong Kong

Central banks of Malaysia and Thailand participate in building cross-border digital currency settlement platform originating from Singapore (Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand)
From Singapore

National Wages Council recommends 6-8% wage increases for high-performing employers, targeting low-income workers (Singapore)
From Singapore

Thai Ministry of Commerce announces progress in ASEAN-Korea FTA revision negotiations (Thailand, ASEAN, South Korea)
From Bangkok

S&F signs MOU with Thai company; leveraging Japanese swimming instruction expertise in Thailand (Thailand, Japan)
From Bangkok

BYD's Indonesia factory opens; focus on whether it leads to local procurement of parts (Indonesia)
From Jakarta

57th GST Council held in New Delhi; proposes streamlining of procedures (India)
From New Delhi

JETRO holds "Japanese Food Showcase" in Bangladesh; seven Japanese companies participate (Bangladesh, Japan)
From Dhaka

JETRO holds first "Japan Career Promotion Forum" in Bhutan (Bhutan, Japan)
From New Delhi

NORTH AMERICA AND LATIN AMERICA

US Federal Communications Commission prohibits distribution of two products containing Chinese-made components; first application of new rules (US, China)
From New York

Mitsubishi Power invests $490 million in Georgia; addressing increased demand for power generation equipment (US, Japan)
From Atlanta

President Trump directs negotiations with each country on wind turbines based on Section 232; does not direct additional tariffs (US)
From New York

US Midterm Elections: CBS News' predictive model for House elections forecasts Democrats winning 229 seats and securing majority (US)
From Research Department, Americas Division

Canada's chief trade negotiator with US explains current status of negotiations; formal trade negotiations not in sight (Canada, US)
From Research Department, Americas Division

Canadian federal and Ontario provincial governments announce 8.7 billion Canadian dollar support package for steel, automotive, and critical minerals (Canada, US)
From Research Department, Americas Division

Hitachi Energy makes additional $77 million investment to expand transformer component production in Brazil (Brazil, Japan)
From São Paulo

Brazil publishes executive order specifying legal framework for gaming industry; includes support measures (Brazil)
From São Paulo

EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA, AND THE CAUCASUS

Machine vision and image processing exhibition "VISION" held in Germany; optical companies from Hamamatsu and others exhibit (Germany, Japan)
From Munich

Netherlands' "CAMERA JAPAN Festival"; Japanese culture expands through film as entry point (Netherlands, Japan)
From Amsterdam

Hungarian government announces outline of 2027 budget "Justice and Growth" (Hungary, EU)